Peter, John, and Jude

1 Peter · 2 Peter 1 and 3 · 1 John · Jude

The big idea: Peter wrote to suffering exiles about a living hope that suffering cannot take away. John wrote to shaken believers so that they may know they have eternal life: God is love, and whoever has the Son has life. Jude blesses the God who is able to keep us from stumbling.

Before you meet: Read

1 Peter 1:3–9 · 1 Peter 4:12–19 · 1 John 4:7–19 · 1 John 5:11–13

Open (5 minutes)

When you are worried, where does your mind go first?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"He has caused us to be born again to a living _____ through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead." *(1 Peter 1:3)*

"If we confess our sins, he is _____ and just to forgive us our sins." *(1 John 1:9)*

"We love because he first _____ us." *(1 John 4:19)*

Discuss

1. Peter says not to be surprised by suffering. Why do Christians so often feel surprised? *1 Peter 4:12–13; 5:7*

2. John writes so that believers may know they have eternal life. Is that kind of certainty proud or humble? *1 John 5:11–13*

3. Jude calls believers to "contend for the faith." How can you do that with the gentleness and respect Peter asks for? *Jude 3; 1 Peter 3:15*

Memory verse

"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."

1 John 1:9

Pray

Give God the anxieties you are carrying. Confess your sins to him, and thank him that he is faithful to forgive and that whoever has the Son has life.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 50

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read 1 Peter 1:3–9 and 1 John 5:11–13 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Revelation 1, 4, and 5).

Main points to land

1. Christians have a living hope that suffering cannot take away (1 Peter 1:3–9; 4:12–13).
2. God is love, and whoever has the Son has life and may know it (1 John 4:7–10; 5:11–13).
3. Jude calls believers to contend for the faith, and points them to the One who is able to keep them from stumbling (Jude 3, 24–25).

Answer key (Observe)

1. hope
2. faithful
3. loved

Questions people will ask

How can anyone be sure they have eternal life?
John wrote so that believers may know (1 John 5:13). Assurance rests first on God's promise in Christ: whoever has the Son has life. It is confirmed by the Spirit's witness and by the fruit of a changed life, like love for God's people (1 John 3:14; Romans 8:16).

Closing prayer

Father, thank you for the living hope you have given us through the resurrection of Jesus, and for the love that makes us your children. Keep us from stumbling. When we suffer, restore and strengthen us, and when we doubt, point us back to your Son. Amen.